

COMSM1201 : Programming in C

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University of Bristol

Built : October 6, 2026



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About the Course

These course notes were originally based on :

C By Dissection (3rd edition)

Al Kelley and Ira Pohl

because I liked arrays being taught late(r).

I've since changed my mind a little & have re-jigged the notes quite heavily over the years.

Resources

- Free : https://en.wikibooks.org/wiki/C_Programming

Resources

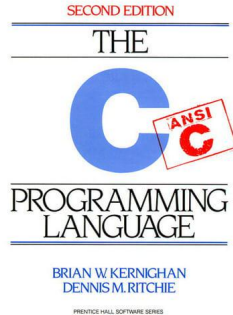
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- Whatever you use, make sure it's **C99** that's being taught, not something else e.g. C11 or C++.
- If you fall in love with C and know you're going to use it for the rest of your life, the reference 'bible' is K&R 2nd edition. It's not a textbook for those new to programming, though.



- Talk to your friends, ask for help, work together.

Computer Science Ethos

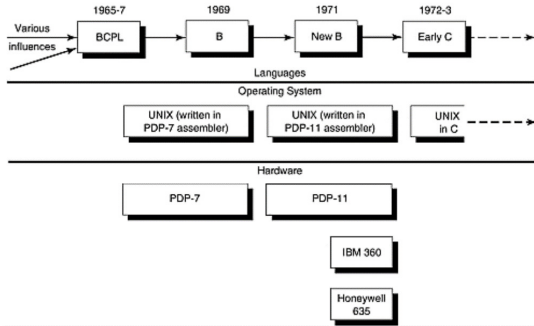
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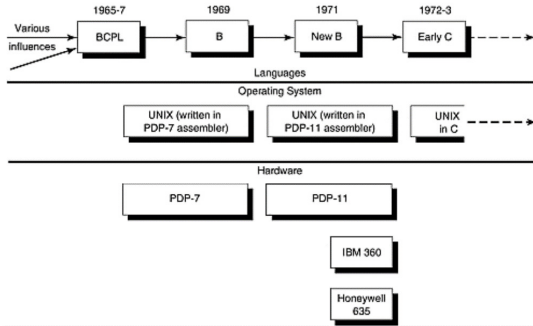
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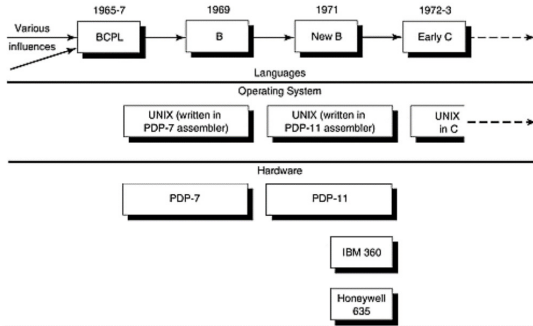
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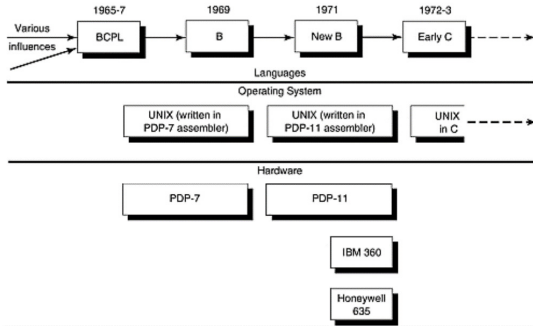
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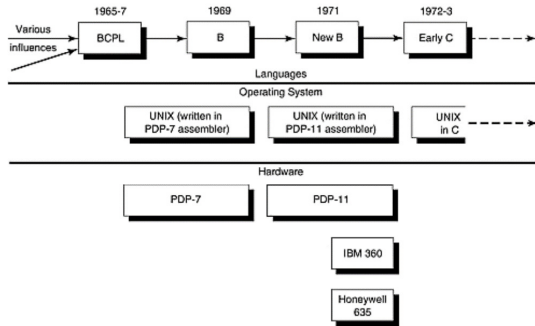
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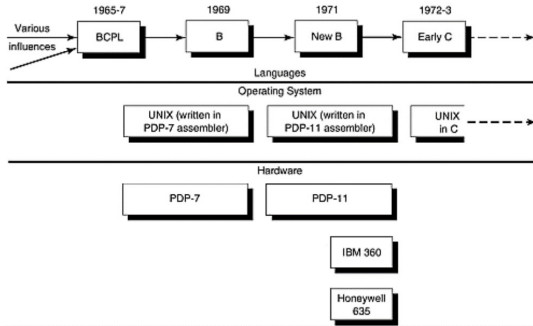
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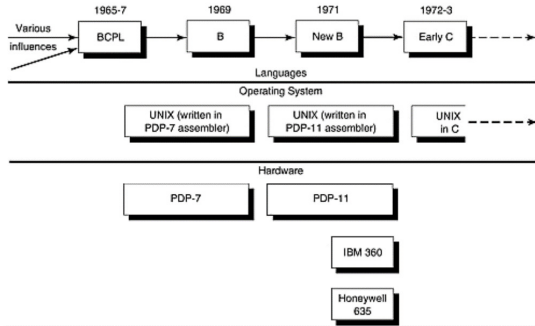
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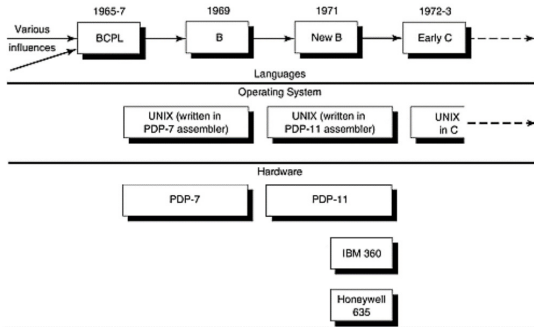
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- C99 (COMSM1201)

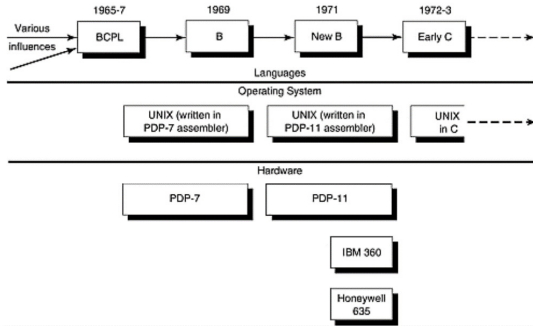
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- ANSI C
- C99 (COMSM1201)
- C++ Object Oriented Programming (OOP)
- Java (Subset of C++, WWW enabled).

Why C ?

Sep 2024	Sep 2023	Change	Programming Language	Ratings	Change
1	1		 Python	20.17%	+6.01%
2	3	▲	 C++	10.75%	+0.09%
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6	6		 JavaScript	3.92%	+0.62%
7	7		 Visual Basic	2.70%	+0.48%
8	12	▲	 Go	2.35%	+1.16%
9	10	▲	 SQL	1.94%	+0.50%
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- Fast ?
- Large parts common to Java

- Lectured 4 hours per week (Neill & Kira) for weeks 1-11 (barring week 6)

Programming and Software Engineering

- Lectured 4 hours per week (Neill & Kira) for weeks 1-11 (barring week 6)
- Programming (C), data structures, algorithms - searching, sorting, string processing, trees etc.

- Weekly (unmarked) exercises that, if completed, should ensure you are able to pass the unit.

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- Three assignments (forming a Coursework Portfolio of 70%) and a final, written exam (30%).
- Timings are slightly variable, so don't make any plans in advance - I'll change it if we're going too fast.

- Any problems with the computers e.g. installing the correct S/W, accessing lab machines :
<http://www.bris.ac.uk/it-services/>

Help with Computers

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- TAs are not allowed to write pieces of code for you, nor undertake detailed bug-fixing of your program.

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Hello World!

```
main( ) {  
    extrn a, b, c;  
    putchar(a); putchar(b); putchar(c); putchar('\n');  
}  
  
a 'hell';  
b 'o, w';  
c 'orld';
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Hello World first seen in: Brian Kernighan, *A Tutorial Introduction to the Language B*, 1972

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```
1  /* The traditional first program  
2  in honour of Dennis Ritchie  
3  who invented C at Bell Labs  
4  in 1972 */  
5  
6  #include <stdio.h>  
7  
8  int main(void)  
9  {  
10  
11      printf("Hello , world!\n");  
12      return 0;  
13  
14  }
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Execution :

Hello , world!

Dissecting the 1st Program

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- The `\n` means print the single character *newline*.
- Notice all declarations and statements are terminated with a semi-colon.
- `return(0)` Instruct the Operating System that the function `main()` has completed successfully.

Area of a Rectangle

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5      // Compute the area of a rectangle
6      int side1, side2, area;
7      side1 = 7;
8      side2 = 8;
9      area = side1 * side2;
10
11     printf("Length of side 1 = %i metres\n", side1);
12     printf("Length of side 2 = %i metres\n", side2);
13     printf("Area of rectangle = %i metres squared\n", area);
14     return 0;
15 }
```

Execution :

Length of side 1 = 7 metres

Length of side 2 = 8 metres

Area of rectangle = 56 metres squared

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3  int main(void)
4  {
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6
7      statements
8  }
```

Arithmetic Operators

- `+` , `-` , `/` , `*` , `%`

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 $1/2$ is 0 , $7/2$ is 3.
- Modulus (Remainder) Arithmetic.
 $7\%4$ is 3, $12\%6$ is 0.
- Only available for integer arithmetic.

The Character Type

```
1 // Demonstration of character arithmetic
2 #include <stdio.h>
3
4 int main(void)
5 {
6     char c;
7
8     c = 'A';
9     printf("%c ", c);
10    printf("%c\n", c+1);
11    return 0;
12 }
```

Execution :

A B

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- Some keyboards have a second single quote the **back quote** ```

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- Used with single quotes i.e. `'A'`, or `'+'`.
- Some keyboards have a second single quote the **back quote** ```
- Note the `%c` conversion format.

Floating Types

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5
6      double x, y;
7
8      x = 1.888888;
9      y = 2.111111;
10
11     printf("Sum of x & y is %f.\n", x + y);
12
13     return 0;
14
15 }
```

Execution :

Sum of x & y is 3.999999.

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- float

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● In C there are three common floating types :

- 1 float
- 2 double

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11     printf("Sum of x & y is %f.\n", x + y);
12
13     return 0;
14
15 }
```

Execution :

Sum of x & y is 3.999999.

● In C there are three common floating types :

- 1 float
- 2 double
- 3 long double

Floating Types

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5
6      double x, y;
7
8      x = 1.888888;
9      y = 2.111111;
10
11     printf("Sum of x & y is %f.\n", x + y);
12
13     return 0;
14
15 }
```

Execution :

Sum of x & y is 3.999999.

- In C there are three common floating types :
 - 1 float
 - 2 double
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- The *Working Type* is doubles.

The Preprocessor

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- `#define PI 3.14159265358979` Replaces all occurrences of `PI` with `3.14159265358979`.
- Include files generally contain other `#define`'s and `#include`'s (amongst other things).

Using printf()

- `printf( fmt-str, arg1, arg2, ...);`

<code>%c</code>	Characters
<code>%i</code>	Integers
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- Fixed Precision: `printf("F:%.2f\n", f);`
F:3.00

Using scanf()

- Similar to printf() but deals with *input* rather than *output*.

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- Note doubles handled differently than floats.

While Loops

```
while (test is true) {  
    statement 1;  
    ...  
    statement n;  
}
```

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while (test is true) {  
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    ...  
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```

```
1  // Sums are computed.  
2  #include <stdio.h>  
3  
4  int main(void)  
5  {  
6  
7      int cnt = 0;  
8      float sum = 0.0, x;  
9      printf("Input some numbers: ");  
10     while (scanf("%f", &x) == 1) {  
11         cnt = cnt + 1;  
12         sum = sum + x;  
13     }  
14  
15     printf("\n%s%5i\n%s%5f\n\n",  
16           "Count:", cnt, "Sum: ", sum);  
17     return 0;  
18 }
```

Execution :

Input some numbers: 1 5 9 10

Count: 4

Sum: 25.000000

Common Mistakes

- Missing "

```
printf("%c\n, ch);
```

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```

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```
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```

- Missing Address in scanf()

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```

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`0b10001` (binary), `17` (decimal), `017` (octal), `0x17` (hexadecimal).
- String Constant enclosed in double-quotes :
`"I am a string"`

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```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5      int a, c = 0;
6      a = ++c;
7      int b = c++;
8      printf("%i %i %i\n", a, b, ++c);
9      return 0;
10 }
```

Question : What is the output ?

Assignment

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- The = operator has a low precedence and a right-to-left associativity.
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- `i = i + 3;` is the same as `i += 3;`
- Many other operators are possible e.g.
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```
1 // 1st few powers of 2 are printed.
2
3 #include <stdio.h>
4
5 int main(void)
6 {
7     int i = 0, power = 1;
8
9     while (++i <= 10){
10         printf("%5i", power *= 2);
11     }
12     printf("\n");
13     return 0;
14 }
```

Execution :

```
      2      4      8      16      32      64      128      256
512 1024
```

The Standard Library

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <stdlib.h>
3
4  int main(void)
5  {
6      printf("Randomly distributed integers are printed.\n"
7            "How many do you want to see? ");
8      int n;
9      if (scanf("%i", &n) == 1){
10         for (int i = 0; i < n; ++i) {
11             if (i % 4 == 0){
12                 printf("\n");
13             }
14             printf("%12i", rand());
15         }
16         printf("\n");
17         return 0;
18     }
19     return 1;
20 }
```

Execution :

Randomly distributed integers are printed.
How many do you want to see? 11

1804289383	846930886	1681692777	1714636915
1957747793	424238335	719885386	1649760492
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- Definitions required for the proper use of many functions such as `rand()` are found in `stdlib.h`.
- Do not mistake these header files for the libraries themselves !

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- Single & and | are *bitwise* operators not comparisons - more on this later.

Short-Circuit Evaluation

```
if(x >= 0.0 && sqrt(x) < 10.0){  
    .... /* Do Something */  
}
```

It's not possible to take the `sqrt()` of a negative number. Here, the `sqrt()` statement is never reached if the first test is *false*. In a logical AND, once any expression is *false*, the whole must be *false*.

The if() Statement

Strictly, you don't need braces if there is only one statement as part of the if :

```
if (expr)
    statement
```

If more than one statement is required :

```
if (expr) {
    statement - 1
    .
    .
    .
    statement - n
}
```

However, we will **always** brace them, even if it's not necessary.

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    .
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}
```

However, we will **always** brace them, even if it's not necessary.

Adding an else statement :

```
if (expr) {
    statement - 1
    .
    .
    statement - n
}
else {
    statement - a
    .
    .
    statement - e
}
```

A Practical Example of if:

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5      int    x, y, z;
6
7      printf("Input three integers: ");
8      if(scanf("%i%i%i", &x, &y, &z) != 3){
9          printf("Didn't get 3 numbers?\n");
10         return 1;
11     }
12     int min;
13     if (x < y){
14         min = x;
15     }
16     // Nasty, dropped braces:
17     else
18         min = y;
19     if (z < min){
20         min = z;
21     }
22     printf("The minimum value is %i\n", min);
23     return 0;
24 }
```

Execution :

Input three integers: 5 7 -4
The minimum value is -4

The while() Statement

```
while(expr)
    statement
```

This, as with the for loop, may execute compound statements :

```
while(expr){
    statement - 1
    .
    .
    .
    statement - n
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However, we will **always** brace them, even if it's not necessary.

```
1  // Simple while countdown
2
3  #include <stdio.h>
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7
8      int n = 9;
9
10     while(n > 0){
11         printf("%i ", n);
12         n--;
13     }
14     printf("\n");
15     return 0;
16 }
```

Execution :

9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1

The for() Loop

This is one of the more complex and heavily used means for controlling execution flow.

```
for( init ; test; loop){  
    statement-1  
    .  
    .  
    .  
    statement-n  
}
```

and may be thought of as :

```
init;  
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In the for() loop, note :

- Semi-colons separate the three parts.

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    loop;  
}
```

In the for() loop, note :

- Semi-colons separate the three parts.
- Any (or all) of the three parts could be empty.
- If the test part is empty, it evaluates to *true*.
- `for(;;){ a+=1; }` is an infinite loop.

A Triply-Nested Loop

```
1 // Triples of integers that sum to N
2 #include <stdio.h>
3
4 #define N 7
5
6 int main(void)
7 {
8     int cnt = 0, i, j, k;
9
10    for(i = 0; i <= N; i++){
11        for(j = 0; j <= N; j++){
12            for(k = 0; k <= N; k++){
13                if(i + j + k == N){
14                    ++cnt;
15                    printf("%3i%3i%3i\n", i, j, k);
16                }
17            }
18        }
19    }
20    printf("\nCount: %i\n", cnt);
21    return 0;
22 }
```

Output :

0	0	7
0	1	6
0	2	5
0	3	4
0	4	3
0	5	2
0	6	1
0	7	0

etc.

4	3	0
5	0	2
5	1	1
5	2	0
6	0	1
6	1	0
7	0	0

Count: 36

The Comma Operator

This has the lowest precedence of all the operators in C and associates left-to-right.

```
a = 0 , b = 1;
```

Hence, the for loop may become quite complex :

```
for(sum = 0, i = 1; i <= n; ++i){  
    sum += i;  
}
```

An equivalent, but more difficult to read expression :

```
for(sum = 0 , i = 1; i <= n; sum += i, ++i);
```

Notice the loop has an empty body, hence the semicolon.

The do-while() Loop

```
do {  
    statement - 1  
    .  
    .  
    .  
    statement - n  
} while ( test );
```

Unlike the while() loop, the do-while() will always be executed at least once.

The do-while() Loop

```
do {  
    statement -1  
    .  
    .  
    .  
    statement -n  
} while ( test );
```

Unlike the while() loop, the do-while() will always be executed at least once.

```
1  // Simple do-while countdown  
2  
3  #include <stdio.h>  
4  
5  int main(void)  
6  {  
7  
8      int n = 9;  
9  
10     /* This program always prints at least one  
11        number, even if n initialised to 0 */  
12     do{  
13         printf("%i ", n);  
14         n--;  
15     }while(n > 0);  
16     printf("\n");  
17     return 0;  
18 }
```

Execution :

9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1

The switch() Statement

```
switch (val) {  
    case 1 :  
        a++;  
        break;  
    case 2 :  
    case 3 :  
        b++;  
        break;  
    default :  
        c++;  
}
```

- The val must be an integer.

The switch() Statement

```
switch (val) {  
    case 1 :  
        a++;  
        break;  
    case 2 :  
    case 3 :  
        b++;  
        break;  
    default :  
        c++;  
}
```

- The val must be an integer.
- The break statement causes execution to jump out of the loop. No break statement causes execution to 'fall through' to the next line.

The switch() Statement

```
switch (val) {  
    case 1 :  
        a++;  
        break;  
    case 2 :  
    case 3 :  
        b++;  
        break;  
    default :  
        c++;  
}
```

- The val must be an integer.
- The break statement causes execution to jump out of the loop. No break statement causes execution to 'fall through' to the next line.
- The default label is a catch-all.

The switch() Statement

```
1  /* A Prime number can only be divided
2     exactly by 1 and itself */
3
4  #include <stdio.h>
5
6  int main(void)
7  {
8
9      int i, n;
10     do{
11         printf("\nEnter a number from 2 - 9 : ");
12         n = scanf("%i", &i);
13     }while( (n!=1) || (i<2) || (i>9) );
14     switch(i){
15         case 2:
16         case 3:
17         case 5:
18         case 7:
19             printf("That's a prime!\n");
20             break;
21         default:
22             printf("That is not a prime!\n");
23     }
24     return 0;
25 }
```

Execution :

Enter a number from 2 - 9 : 1

Enter a number from 2 - 9 : 0

Enter a number from 2 - 9 : 10

Enter a number from 2 - 9 : 3

That's a prime!

The Conditional (?) Operator

As we have seen, C programmers have a range of techniques available to reduce the amount of typing :

```
expr1 ? expr2 : expr3
```

If `expr1` is *true* then `expr2` is executed, else `expr3` is evaluated.

The Conditional (?) Operator

As we have seen, C programmers have a range of techniques available to reduce the amount of typing :

```
expr1 ? expr2 : expr3
```

If `expr1` is *true* then `expr2` is executed, else `expr3` is evaluated.

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5      int    x, y, z;
6
7      printf("Input three integers: ");
8      if (scanf("%i%i%i", &zx, &zy, &zz) != 3){
9          printf("Didn't get 3 numbers?\n");
10         return 1;
11     }
12     int min;
13     min = (x < y) ? x : y;
14     min = (z < min) ? z : min;
15     printf("The minimum value is %i\n", min);
16     return 0;
17 }
```

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J : 2D Arrays & More Types

K : Pointers

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Simple Functions

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int min(int a, int b);
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7
8      int j, k, m;
9
10     printf("Input two integers: ");
11     scanf("%i%i", &j, &k);
12     m = min(j, k);
13     printf("\nOf the two values %i and %i, " \
14           "the minimum is %i.\n\n", j, k, m);
15     return 0;
16 }
17
18
19 int min(int a, int b)
20 {
21     if (a < b)
22         return a;
23     else
24         return b;
25 }
```

Execution :

Input two integers: 5 2

Of the two values 5 and 2, the minimum is 2.

Simple Functions

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
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3  int min(int a, int b);
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10     printf("Input two integers: ");
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13     printf("\nOf the two values %i and %i, " \
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19 int min(int a, int b)
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23     else
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25 }
```

- Execution begins, as normal, in the main() function.

Execution :

Input two integers: 5 2

Of the two values 5 and 2, the minimum is 2.

Simple Functions

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int min(int a, int b);
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10     printf("Input two integers: ");
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```

- Execution begins, as normal, in the `main()` function.
- The function *prototype is shown* at the top of the file. This allows the compiler to check the code more thoroughly.

Execution :

Input two integers: 5 2

Of the two values 5 and 2, the minimum is 2.

Simple Functions

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int min(int a, int b);
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Execution :

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11     scanf("%i%i", &j, &k);
12     m = min(j, k);
13     printf("\nOf the two values %i and %i, " \
14           "the minimum is %i.\n\n", j, k, m);
15     return 0;
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19 int min(int a, int b)
20 {
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```

Execution :

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- Execution begins, as normal, in the `main()` function.
- The function *prototype is shown* at the top of the file. This allows the compiler to check the code more thoroughly.
- The function is defined between two braces.
- The function `min()` returns an `int` and takes two `int`'s as arguments. These are copies of `j` and `k`.

Simple Functions

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1  #include <stdio.h>
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10     printf("Input two integers: ");
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Execution :

Input two integers: 5 2

Of the two values 5 and 2, the minimum is 2.

- Execution begins, as normal, in the `main()` function.
- The function *prototype is shown* at the top of the file. This allows the compiler to check the code more thoroughly.
- The function is defined between two braces.
- The function `min()` returns an `int` and takes two `int`'s as arguments. These are copies of `j` and `k`.
- The `return` statement is used to return a value to the calling statement.

Call-by-Value

In the following example, a function is passed an integer using call by value:

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  void fnc1(int x);
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7      int x = 1;
8
9      fnc1(x);
10     printf("%i\n", x);
11 }
12
13 void fnc1(int x)
14 {
15     x = x + 1;
16 }
```

Execution :

1

Call-by-Value

In the following example, a function is passed an integer using call by value:

```
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3  void fnc1(int x);
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13 void fnc1(int x)
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```

Execution :

1

- The function does not change the value of `x` in `main()`, since `x` in the function is effectively only a **copy** of the variable.

Call-by-Value

In the following example, a function is passed an integer using call by value:

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1  #include <stdio.h>
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3  void fnc1(int x);
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9      fnc1(x);
10     printf("%i\n", x);
11 }
12
13 void fnc1(int x)
14 {
15     x = x + 1;
16 }
```

Execution :

1

- The function does not change the value of `x` in `main()`, since `x` in the function is effectively only a **copy** of the variable.
- A function which has no return value, is declared `void` and, in other languages, might be termed a *procedure*.

Call-by-Value

In the following example, a function is passed an integer using call by value:

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1  #include <stdio.h>
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3  void fnc1(int x);
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5  int main(void)
6  {
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9      fnc1(x);
10     printf("%i\n", x);
11 }
12
13 void fnc1(int x)
14 {
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16 }
```

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1

- The function does not change the value of `x` in `main()`, since `x` in the function is effectively only a **copy** of the variable.
- A function which has no return value, is declared `void` and, in other languages, might be termed a *procedure*.
- Most parameters used as arguments to functions in C are copied - this is known as *call-by-value*. We'll see the alternative, *call-by-reference*, later.

Testing

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int numfactors(int f);
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7
8      int n = 12;
9      printf("Number of factors in %i is %i\n", \
10             n, numfactors(n));
11     return 0;
12 }
13
14 int numfactors(int k)
15 {
16
17     int count = 0;
18
19     for(int i=1; i<=k; i++){
20         if( (k%i)==0) {
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- This is a (not very good) function to compute the number of factors a number has.

Testing

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- This is a (not very good) function to compute the number of factors a number has.
- A factor is a number by which a larger (whole/integer) number can be divided.

Testing

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- This is a (not very good) function to compute the number of factors a number has.
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- 12 has 6 factors: 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 and 12 itself.

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- How do we know the program works though ?

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- Running it ?

Number of factors in 12 is 6

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- This is a (not very good) function to compute the number of factors a number has.
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- 12 has 6 factors: 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 and 12 itself.
- How do we know the program works though ?
- Running it ?
Number of factors in 12 is 6
- We need something more automated.

Pre- and Post-Conditions

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <assert.h>
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12     return 0;
13 }
14
15 int numfactors(int k)
16 {
17
18     int count = 0;
19
20     assert(k >= 1); // Avoid trying zero
21     for(int i=1; i<=k; i++){
22         if( (k%i)==0) {
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25     }
26     assert(count <= k);
27     return count;
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```

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- Pre-conditions check the inputs to functions, typically their arguments.

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- Post-conditions check the returns from functions.

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- Pre-conditions check the inputs to functions, typically their arguments.
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- An assert simply states some test that **ought** to be true. If not, the program aborts with an error.

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```

- Pre-conditions check the inputs to functions, typically their arguments.
- Post-conditions check the returns from functions.
- An assert simply states some test that **ought** to be true. If not, the program aborts with an error.
- There's a sense that this is somehow *safer*, but we haven't exactly done much testing on it to ensure the correct answers are returned.

Assert Testing

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <assert.h>
3
4  int numfactors(int f);
5
6  int main(void)
7  {
8      assert(numfactors(17) == 2);
9      assert(numfactors(12) == 6);
10     assert(numfactors(6) == 4);
11     assert(numfactors(1) == 1);
12     assert(numfactors(0) == 0); // ?
13     return 0;
14 }
15
16 int numfactors(int k)
17 {
18
19     int count = 0;
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21     for(int i=1; i<=k; i++){
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Assert Testing

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13     return 0;
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```

- We will use assert testing in this style **every** time we write a function.

Assert Testing

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
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4  int numfactors(int f);
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- We will use assert testing in this style **every** time we write a function.
- These tests tend to get quite long, so we generally collect them in a function called test() which itself is called from main().

Assert Testing

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2  #include <assert.h>
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4  int numfactors(int f);
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12     assert(numfactors(0) == 0); // ?
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27 }
```

- We will use assert testing in this style **every** time we write a function.
- These tests tend to get quite long, so we generally collect them in a function called test() which itself is called from main().
- If there is no error, there is no output from this program.

Assert Testing

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <assert.h>
3
4  int numfactors(int f);
5
6  int main(void)
7  {
8      assert(numfactors(17) == 2);
9      assert(numfactors(12) == 6);
10     assert(numfactors(6) == 4);
11     assert(numfactors(1) == 1);
12     assert(numfactors(0) == 0); // ?
13     return 0;
14 }
15
16 int numfactors(int k)
17 {
18
19     int count = 0;
20
21     for(int i=1; i<=k; i++){
22         if( (k%i)==0) {
23             count++;
24         }
25     }
26     return count;
27 }
```

- We will use assert testing in this style **every** time we write a function.
- These tests tend to get quite long, so we generally collect them in a function called test() which itself is called from main().
- If there is no error, there is no output from this program.
- If you #define NDEBUG before the #include <assert.h>, all assertions are ignored, allowing them to be used during development and switched off later.

Self-test : Multiply

- Write a simple function `int mul(int a, int b)` which multiplies two integers together **without** the use of the multiply symbol in C (i.e. the `*`)

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1  /* Try to write mul(a,b) without using
2     any maths cleverer than addition.    */
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11 {
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17 int mul( int a,  int b)
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20     // To be completed
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24 void test(void)
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28     assert(mul(0,3) == 0);
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- Write a simple function `int mul(int a, int b)` which multiplies two integers together **without** the use of the multiply symbol in C (i.e. the `*`)
- Use iteration (a loop) to achieve this.
- 7×8 is computed by adding 7, eight times.
- Use `assert()` calls to test it thoroughly - I've given you some to get you started.

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Program Layout

It is normal for the `main()` function to come first in a program :

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>

list of function prototypes

int main(void)
{
    . . . . .
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int f1(int a, int b)
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However, it is theoretically possible to avoid the need for function prototypes by defining a function before it is used :

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    . . . . .
}
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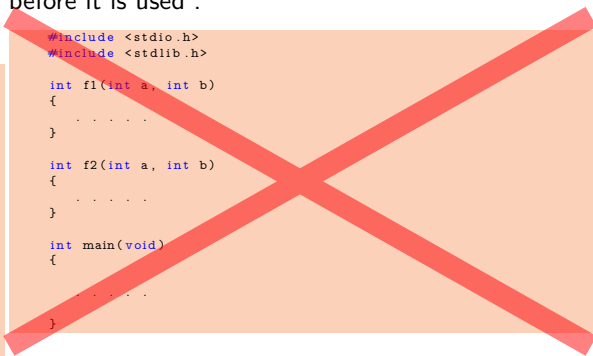
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}

int main(void)
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    . . . . .
}
```

We will **never** use this second approach - put `main()` first with the prototypes above it.

Replacing Functions with Macros

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  #define MIN(A, B) ((A)<(B)?(A):(B))
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7
8      int j, k, m;
9
10     printf("Input two integers: ");
11     scanf("%i%i", &j, &k);
12     m = MIN(j, k);
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16 }
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Execution :

Input two integers: 5 2

Minimum is 2

Replacing Functions with Macros

- There's sometimes a (tiny) time penalty for using functions.

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- There's a "double evaluation" problem though - what happens if we used `m = MIN(j++, k++)`; ?
- This is expanded to `((j++)<(k++)?(j++):(k++))` which is **not** what was intended.

The inline modifier

- In C99 the inline modifier was introduced
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Inline_function

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
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3  static inline int min(int a, int b);
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[//en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Inline_function](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Inline_function)

... serves as a compiler directive that suggests (but does not require) that the compiler substitute the body of the function inline by performing inline expansion, i.e. by inserting the function code at the address of each function call, thereby saving the overhead of a function call.

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... serves as a compiler directive that suggests (but does not require) that the compiler substitute the body of the function inline by performing inline expansion, i.e. by inserting the function code at the address of each function call, thereby saving the overhead of a function call.
- Since most compilers have the ability to do this for you, you never need to do this.

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7  {
8      assert(fact(4) == 24);
9      assert(fact(1) == 1);
10     assert(fact(0) == 1);
11     assert(fact(10) == 3628800);
12     return 0;
13 }
14
15 int fact(int a)
16 {
17
18     int tot = 1;
19     for(int i=1; i<=a; i++){
20         tot *= i;
21     }
22     return tot;
23 }
24
25 }
```


Factorials via Recursion (Advanced)

- We could achieve the same result using recursion.

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Factorials via Recursion (Advanced)

- We could achieve the same result using recursion.
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- A recursive function calls *itself* - there may be many versions of the same function 'alive' at the same time during execution.

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Table of Contents

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K : Pointers

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Fundamental Data types

- [unsigned | signed]

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Type	Minimum size (bits)	Format specifier
char	8	%c
signed char	8	%c (or %hhi for numerical output)
unsigned char	8	%c (or %hhu for numerical output)
short short int signed short signed short int	16	%hi or %hi
unsigned short unsigned short int	16	%hu
int signed signed int	16	Identical for printf : %i or %d For scanf, %d input decimal only For scanf, %i auto-detects format (octal,decimal,hex)
unsigned unsigned int	16	%u
long long int signed long signed long int	32	%ld or %li
unsigned long unsigned long int	32	%lu
long long long long int signed long long signed long long int	64	%lli or %lld
unsigned long long unsigned long long int	64	%llu
float		scanf(): %f, %g, %e, %a
double		%lf, %lg, %le, %la
long double		%Lf, %Lg, %Le, %La

Binary Storage of Numbers

In an unsigned char :

2^7	2^6	2^5	2^4	2^3	2^2	2^1	2^0
0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0

The above represents :

$$1 * 64 + 1 * 8 + 1 * 4 = 76.$$

- Floating operations need not be exact.

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5
6      float d = 0.1;
7      printf("%.12f\n", 3.0*d);
8      return 0;
9  }
```

Execution :

0.3000000004470

Binary Storage of Numbers

In an unsigned char :

2^7	2^6	2^5	2^4	2^3	2^2	2^1	2^0
0	1	0	0	1	1	0	0

The above represents :

$$1 * 64 + 1 * 8 + 1 * 4 = 76.$$

- Floating operations need not be exact.

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
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3  int main(void)
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6      float d = 0.1;
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```

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if ( d == 0.3 )
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```
if ( d == 0.3 )
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- Therefore, we don't allow this by explicitly using the compiler warning flag:
-Wfloat-equal

sizeof()

To find the exact size in bytes of a type on a particular machine, use sizeof(). On a Dell Windows 10 laptop running WSL:

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  int main(void)
4  {
5
6      printf("char      :%3li\n", sizeof(char));
7      printf("short     :%3li\n", sizeof(short));
8      printf("long      :%3li\n", sizeof(long));
9      printf("unsigned   :%3li\n", sizeof(unsigned));
10     printf("long long  :%3li\n", sizeof(long long));
11     printf("float      :%3li\n", sizeof(float));
12     printf("dbl        :%3li\n", sizeof(double));
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Execution :

char	:	1
short	:	2
long	:	8
unsigned	:	4
long long	:	8
float	:	4
dbl	:	8
long dbl	:	16

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 - `sqrt()` `pow()` `round()`
 - `fabs()` `exp()` `log()`
 - `sin()` `cos()` `tan()`
- Most take doubles as arguments and return doubles.

Casting

```
1  /* Compute the Volume of a Sphere
2     to the nearest integer      */
3  #include <stdio.h>
4  #include <math.h>
5
6  #define PI 3.14159265358979323846
7
8  int main(void)
9  {
10     double r;
11     printf("Enter a radius : ");
12     scanf("%lf", &r);
13     // Make sure radius is positive
14     r = fabs(r);
15     double v = 4.0 / 3.0 * PI * pow(r, (double) 3);
16     printf("Volume of your ball = %f\n", v);
17     printf("Volume of your ball = %.2f\n", v);
18     printf("Volume of your ball = %i\n", (int)v);
19     printf("Volume of your ball = %.0f\n", v);
20     printf("Volume of your ball = %f\n", round(v));
21     return 0;
22 }
```

- An explicit type conversion is called a *cast*.

Execution :

```
Enter a radius : 7.75
Volume of your ball = 1949.816390
Volume of your ball = 1949.82
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- An explicit type conversion is called a *cast*.
- *If it moves - cast it*. Don't trust the compiler to do it for you !

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- Declaration:

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- The particular integer used to represent a character is dependent on the encoding used. The most common of these, used on most UNIX and PC platforms, is ASCII.

lowercase	'a'	'b'	'c'	...	'z'
ASCII value	97	98	99	...	122
uppercase	'A'	'B'	'C'	...	'Z'
ASCII value	65	66	67	...	90
digit	'0'	'1'	'2'	...	'9'
ASCII value	48	49	50	...	57
other	'&'	'*'	'+'	...	
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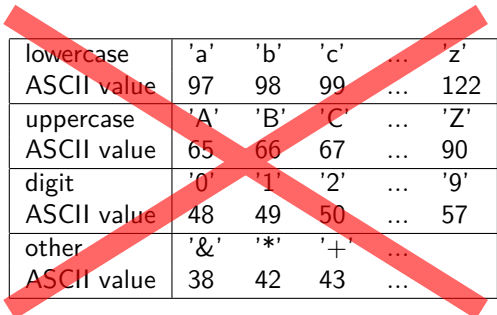
```
char c;
```

```
c = 'A';
```

```
or :
```

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char c1 = 'A', c2 = '*', c3 = ';' ;
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Using Characters

- When using `printf()` and `scanf()` the formats `%c` and `%i` do very different things :

```
char c = 'a'  
printf("%c\n", c); /* prints : a */  
printf("%i\n", c); /* prints : 97 */
```

Escape sequence	Hex value	Character
<code>\a</code>	07	Alert (Beep, Bell)
<code>\b</code>	08	Backspace
<code>\e</code>	1B	Escape character
<code>\f</code>	0C	Formfeed Page Break
<code>\n</code>	0A	Newline (Line Feed)
<code>\r</code>	0D	Carriage Return
<code>\t</code>	09	Horizontal Tab
<code>\v</code>	0B	Vertical Tab
<code>\\</code>	5C	Backslash
<code>\'</code>	27	Apostrophe
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<code>\?</code>	3F	Question mark

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```
char c = 'a';  
printf("%c\n", c); /* prints : a */  
printf("%i\n", c); /* prints : 97 */
```
- Hard-to-print characters have an escape sequence i.e. to print a newline, the 2 character escape `'\n'` is used.

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Using getchar() and putchar()

```
1 // Outputs characters twice
2
3 #include <stdio.h>
4
5 int main(void)
6 {
7
8     char c;
9
10    do{
11        c = getchar();
12        putchar(c);
13        putchar(c);
14    }while(c != '!');
15    putchar('\n');
16
17    return 0;
18 }
```

Execution :

```
abc123!
aabbcc112233!!
```

This has the unfortunate problem of requiring a 'special' character to terminate. More aggressively, the user could terminate by pressing CTRL-C.

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```
1 // Outputs characters twice
2
3 #include <stdio.h>
4
5 int main(void)
6 {
7     char c; // char or int ?
8
9     while ((c = getchar()) != EOF) {
10         putchar(c);
11         putchar(c);
12     }
13     putchar('\n');
14
15     return 0;
16 }
17 }
```

Execution :

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abc123
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The end-of-file constant is defined in `stdio.h`. Although system dependent, `-1` is often used. On the UNIX system this is generated when the end of a file being piped is reached, or when CTRL-D is pressed.

Capitalization

```
1 // Outputs characters twice
2
3 #include <stdio.h>
4
5 #define CAPS ('A' - 'a')
6
7 int main(void)
8 {
9     int c;
10    while ((c = getchar()) != '!'){
11        if (c >= 'a' && c <= 'z'){
12            putchar(c + CAPS);
13        }
14        else{
15            putchar(c);
16        }
17    }
18    putchar('\n');
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Execution :

```
Hello World!
HELLO WORLD
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This is more easily achieved by using some of the definitions found in `ctype.h`.

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Macro	true returned if:
<code>isalnum(int c)</code>	Letter or digit
<code>isalpha(int c)</code>	Letter
<code>iscntrl(int c)</code>	Control character
<code>isdigit(int c)</code>	Digit
<code>isgraph(int c)</code>	Printable (not space)
<code>islower(int c)</code>	Lowercase
<code>isprint(int c)</code>	Printable
<code>ispunct(int c)</code>	Punctuation
<code>isspace(int c)</code>	White Space
<code>isupper(int c)</code>	Uppercase
<code>isxdigit(int c)</code>	Hexadecimal
<code>isascii(int c)</code>	ASCII code

Some useful functions are :

Function/Macro	Returns:
int tolower(int c)	Lowercase c
int toupper(int c)	Uppercase c
int toascii(int c)	ASCII code for c

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <cctype.h>
3
4  int main(void)
5  {
6
7      int c;
8      while ((c = getchar()) != EOF){
9          if (islower(c)){
10             putchar(toupper(c));
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10             chars unaltered */
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Table of Contents

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K : Pointers

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enum day { sun, mon, tue, wed, thu, fri, sat};
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enum day d1;
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enum fruit{apple=7, pear, orange=3, lemon};
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- Note that the type is `enum day`; the keyword `enum` is not enough.

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- Makes code self-documenting.
- Helps to control complexity when programmers are building complicated or lengthy user-defined types (See Structures later).

Combining typedefs and enums

- Often typedef's are used in conjunction with enumerated types:

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <assert.h>

enum day {mon,tue,wed,thu,fri,sat,sun};
typedef enum day day;

day find_next_day(day d);

int main(void)
{
    assert(find_next_day(mon)==tue);
    assert(find_next_day(sat)==sun);
    assert(find_next_day(sun)==mon);
    return 0;
}
```

```
day find_next_day(day d)
{
    day next_day;
    switch(d){
        case sun:
            next_day = mon;
            break;
        case mon:
            next_day = tue;
            break;
        case tue:
            next_day = wed;
            break;
        case wed:
            next_day = thu;
            break;
        case thu:
            next_day = fri;
            break;
        case fri:
            next_day = sat;
            break;
        case sat:
            next_day = sun;
            break;
        default:
            printf("I wasn't expecting that !\n");
    }
    return next_day;
}
```

```
enum veg {beet, carrot, pea};  
typedef enum veg veg;  
veg v1, v2;  
v1 = carrot;
```

- We can combine the two operations into one:

```
typedef enum veg {beet,carrot,pea} veg;  
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veg v1, v2;  
v1 = carrot;
```

- Assigning:

```
v1 = 10;
```

is very poor programming style !

Booleans

- Before C99 you might have been tempted to define your own Boolean type:

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <assert.h>
3
4  typedef enum bool {false, true} bool;
5
6  int main(void)
7  {
8
9      bool b = true;
10     if (b){
11         printf("It's true!\n");
12     }
13     else{
14         printf("It's false!\n");
15     }
16     return 0;
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```

Execution :

It's true!

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12     }
13     else{
14         printf("It's false!\n");
15     }
16     return 0;
17 }
```

Execution :

It 's true!

- However, we can just use `#include <stdbool.h>`

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <stdbool.h>
3  #include <assert.h>
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7
8      bool b = true;
9      if (b){
10         printf("It's true!\n");
11     }
12     else{
13         printf("It's false!\n");
14     }
15     return 0;
16 }
```

Execution :

It 's true!

Rewrite/complete this code using typedefs and enums to create self-documenting code in any manner you wish.

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <assert.h>
3
4  // Argument 1 is temperature
5  // Argument 2 is scale (0=>Celsius, 1=>Fahrenheit)
6  int fvr(double t, int s);
7
8  int main(void)
9  {
10     assert(fvr(37.5, 0)==1);
11     assert(fvr(36.5, 0)==0);
12     assert(fvr(96.5, 1)==0);
13     assert(fvr(99.5, 1)==1);
14     return 0;
15 }
16
17 int fvr(double t, int s)
18 {
19 }
```


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1D Arrays

- One-Dimensional arrays are declared by a type followed by an identifier with a bracketed constant expression:

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float x[10];
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we prevent these using the `-Wvla` compiler flag.

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- Arrays are indexed **0** to **n-1**.

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2
3  #define N 500
4
5  int main(void)
6  {
7
8      /* allocate space a[0]...a[N-1] */
9      int a[N];
10     int i, sum = 0;
11     /* fill array */
12     for (i = 0; i < N; ++i){
13         a[i] = 7 + i * i;
14     }
15     /* print array */
16     for (i = 0; i < N; ++i){
17         printf("a[%i]=%i ", i, a[i]);
18     }
19     /* sum elements */
20     for (i = 0; i < N; ++i){
21         sum += a[i];
22     }
23     /* print sum */
24     printf("\nsum=%i\n", sum);
25     return 0;
26 }
```

1D Arrays : Initialisation

By default, arrays are uninitialised. When they are declared, they may be assigned a value:

```
float x[7] = {-1.1,0.2,2.0,4.4,6.5,0.0,7.7};
```

or,

```
float x[7] = {-1.1, 0.2};
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the elements 2 ... 6 are set to zero.

Also:

```
int a[] = {3, 8, 9, 1};
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is valid, the compiler assumes the array size to be 4.

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is valid, the compiler assumes the array size to be 4.

- `a[5] = a[4] + 1;`
- `k[9]++;`
- `n[12+i] = 0;`
- Accessing an array out of bounds will not be identified by the compiler. It may cause an error at run-time. One frequent result is that an entirely unrelated variable is altered.

1D Arrays : Call by Reference

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <math.h>
3  #include <assert.h>
4  #define MAX 5
5
6  // Pass array, AND number of elements
7  void set_array(int a[MAX], unsigned int len, int n);
8
9  int main(void)
10 {
11     int x[MAX] = {2, 3, 3, 3, 3};
12     set_array(x, 5, 3); assert(x[0] == 3);
13     x[0] = 5; x[1] = 5; x[2] = 5; x[3] = 5; x[4] = 5;
14     set_array(x, 5, 4); assert(x[2] == 4);
15     set_array(x, 1, 0); assert(x[0] == 0);
16     x[0] = 1; x[1] = 2; x[2] = 3;
17     set_array(x, 3, 2);
18     assert(x[2] == 2); assert(x[3] == 4);
19 }
20
21 // Set all values of array (size len) to n
22 void set_array(int a[MAX], unsigned int len, int n)
23 {
24     if(len == 0){
25         return;
26     }
27     for(unsigned int i=0; i<len; i++){
28         a[i] = n;
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- Here, the array is passed by *Reference* - no copy of the array is made - the function processes the array that was created inside `main()`, despite it apparently having a 'different' name.
- All arrays are passed like this in C - we'll see later when we look at *pointers* why this is the case.

Structures

- A structure type allows the programmer to aggregate components into a single, named variable. Other languages call these *Records* or *Tuples*.

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 actually creates storage for the variables.
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- ```
e1.salary = 35000.2;
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```
- The member name must be unique within the same structure.
- Arrays of structures are possible, i.e.:  

```
struct employee team[400];
```

# Arrays of Structures

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdbool.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <assert.h>

#define SUITS 4
#define PERSUIT 13
#define DECK (SUITS*PERSUIT)
#define SHUFFLE 3

typedef enum {hearts, diamonds, spades, clubs} suit;

struct card {
 suit st;
 int pips;
};
typedef struct card card;

void shuffle_deck(card d[DECK]);
void init_deck(card d[DECK]);
void print_deck(card d[DECK], int n);
void test(void);

int main(void)
{
 card d[DECK];

 test();
 init_deck(d);
 print_deck(d, 7);
 shuffle_deck(d);
 print_deck(d, 7);
 return 0;
}
```

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 print_deck(d, 7);
 return 0;
}
```

```
void init_deck(card d[DECK])
{
 for(int i=0; i<DECK; i++){
 // Number 1 .. 13
 d[i].pips = (i%PERSUIT) + 1;
 switch (i/PERSUIT) {
 case hearts: d[i].st = hearts; break;
 case diamonds: d[i].st = diamonds; break;
 case spades: d[i].st = spades; break;
 case clubs: d[i].st = clubs; break;
 // Force an abort ?
 default : assert(false);
 }
 }
}

void shuffle_deck(card d[DECK])
{
 for(int i=0; i<SHUFFLE*DECK; i++){
 int n1 = rand()%DECK;
 int n2 = rand()%DECK;
 card c = d[n1]; d[n1] = d[n2]; d[n2] = c;
 }
}
```

# Arrays of Structures

```
void print_deck(card d[DECK], int n)
{
 for(int i=0; i<n; i++){
 switch(d[i].pips){
 case 11:
 printf("Jack");
 break;
 case 12:
 printf("Queen");
 break;
 case 13:
 printf("King");
 break;
 default:
 printf("%2i", d[i].pips);
 }
 switch(d[i].st){
 case hearts :
 printf(" of Hearts\n");
 break;
 case diamonds :
 printf(" of Diamonds\n");
 break;
 case spades:
 printf(" of Spades\n");
 break;
 default :
 printf(" of Clubs\n");
 }
 }
 printf("\n");
}
```

Execution :

```
1 of Hearts
2 of Hearts
3 of Hearts
4 of Hearts
5 of Hearts
6 of Hearts
7 of Hearts

4 of Spades
Jack of Spades
7 of Clubs
9 of Spades
10 of Spades
7 of Hearts
2 of Spades
```

- The print\_deck() function is clearly messy ! We can simplify this a little when we understand strings.

- Note the direct ability to copy a structure.

```
void test(void)
{
 int n = 0;
 card d[DECK];
 init_deck(d);
 // Direct assignment
 card c = {hearts, 10};
 // 1st element initialised correctly
 assert(d[9].pips == c.pips);
 assert(d[9].st == c.st);
 for(int i=0; i<1000; i++){
 shuffle_deck(d);
 // Happens 1 time in 52 ?
 if((d[0].st == c.st) && (d[0].pips == c.pips)){
 n++;
 }
 }
 // Is this a reasonable test ?
 assert((n > 10) && (n < 30));
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```

# Testing

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- Tricky to think of a good test for `shuffle_deck`.

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- Note the direct ability to copy a structure.
- You can't compare them using == though.
- Tricky to think of a good test for shuffle\_deck.
- You could also typedef away the array, e.g.:

typedef card deck[DECK];

void shuffle\_deck(deck d);

But this hides the fact it's an array (which seems odd?)



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- The important difference between strings and ordinary arrays is the **end-of-string sentinel** `'\0'` or null character.

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- Any character in a string may be accessed as an array element.
- The important difference between strings and ordinary arrays is the **end-of-string sentinel** `'\0'` or null character.
- The string "abc" has a *length* of 3, but its *size* is 4.

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## Initialising Strings :

- `char w[6] = "Hello";`



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## Initialising Strings :

- `char w[6] = "Hello";`
- `char w[250];`  
`w[0] = 'a';`  
`w[1] = 'b';`  
`w[2] = 'c';`  
`w[3] = '\0';`

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## Initialising Strings :

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`w[1] = 'b';`  
`w[2] = 'c';`  
`w[3] = '\0';`
- `scanf("%s", w);`  
Removes leading spaces, reads a string (terminated by a space or EOF). Adds a null character to the end of the string.

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## Initialising Strings :

- `char w[6] = "Hello";`
- `char w[250];`  
`w[0] = 'a';`  
`w[1] = 'b';`  
`w[2] = 'c';`  
`w[3] = '\0';`
- `scanf("%s", w);`  
Removes leading spaces, reads a string (terminated by a space or EOF). Adds a null character to the end of the string.
- `char w[250] = {'a', 'b', 'c', '\0'};`

# Unused Letters and string.h

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2 #include <stdbool.h>
3 #include <ctype.h>
4
5 #define ALPHASIZE 26
6
7 int main(void)
8 {
9 char s[100] = "The Quick Brown Fox Leaps" \
10 "Over the Lazy Dog";
11 bool used[ALPHASIZE] = {false};
12 int i = 0;
13 while(s[i]){
14 char c = tolower(s[i]);
15 if(islower(c)){
16 used[c - 'a'] = true;
17 }
18 i++;
19 }
20 for(i=0; i<ALPHASIZE; i++){
21 if(!used[i]){
22 printf("%c has not been used.\n", i+'a');
23 }
24 }
25 return 0;
26 }
```

Execution :

```
j has not been used.
m has not been used.
```

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In #include <string.h> :

```
char *strcat(char dest[], const char src[]);
int strcmp(const char s1[], const char s2[]);
```

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Execution :

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In `#include <string.h>` :

```
char *strcat(char dest[], const char src[]);
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- `strcat()` appends a copy of string `src`, including the terminating null character, to the end of string `dst`.

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8 {
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10 "Over the Lazy Dog";
11 bool used[ALPHASIZE] = {false};
12 int i = 0;
13 while(s[i]){
14 char c = tolower(s[i]);
15 if(islower(c)){
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j has not been used.
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In `#include <string.h>` :

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char *strcat(char dest[], const char src[]);
int strcmp(const char s1[], const char s2[]);
```

- `strcat()` appends a copy of string `src`, including the terminating null character, to the end of string `dst`.
- `strcmp()` compares two strings byte-by-byte, according to the ordering of your machine's character set. The function returns an integer greater than, equal to, or less than 0, if the string pointed to by `s1` is greater than, equal to, or less than the string pointed to by `s2` respectively.

# More string.h

```
In #include <string.h> :
```

```
char *strcpy(char dst[], const char src[]);
unsigned strlen(const char s[]);
```



# More string.h

In `#include <string.h>` :

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char *strcpy(char dst[], const char src[]);
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- `strcpy()` copies string `src` to `dst` including the terminating null character, stopping after the null character has been copied.

In `#include <string.h>` :

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- `strcpy()` copies string `src` to `dst` including the terminating null character, stopping after the null character has been copied.
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- `strcpy()` copies string `src` to `dst` including the terminating null character, stopping after the null character has been copied.
- `strlen()` returns the number of bytes in `s`, not including the terminating null character.

One way to write the function `strlen()` :

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2 #include <assert.h>
3
4 unsigned nstrlen(const char s[]);
5
6 int main(void)
7 {
8 assert(nstrlen("Neill")==5);
9 assert(nstrlen("")==0);
10 assert(nstrlen("\n")==1);
11 assert(nstrlen("abcdef")==nstrlen("fedcba"));
12 return 0;
13 }
14
15 unsigned nstrlen(const char s[])
16 {
17 register unsigned n = 0;
18
19 while(s[n] != '\0'){
20 ++n;
21 }
22 return n;
23 }
```

# The snprintf() Function

In `#include <string.h>` : This is very similar to the function `printf()`, except that the output is stored in a string rather than written to the output. It is defined as:

```
int snprintf(string, str-size, control-
arg, other args);
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```
int snprintf(string, str-size, control-
arg, other args);
```

For example:

```
int i = 7;
float f = 17.041;
char str[100];
snprintf(str, 100, "%i %f", i, f);
printf("%s\n", str);
```

Outputs : 7 17.041000

This is useful if you need to create a string for passing to another function for further processing.

# The snprintf() Function

In `#include <string.h>` : This is very similar to the function `printf()`, except that the output is stored in a string rather than written to the output. It is defined as:

`int snprintf(string, str-size, control-arg, other args);`

For example:

```
int i = 7;
float f = 17.041;
char str[100];
snprintf(str, 100, "%i %f", i, f);
printf("%s\n", str);
```

Outputs : 7 17.041000

This is useful if you need to create a string for passing to another function for further processing.

```
#define SMALLSTR 20
void print_card(char s[BIGSTR], card c)
{
 char pipstr[SMALLSTR];
 char suitstr[SMALLSTR];
 switch(c.pips){
 case 11:
 strcpy(pipstr, "Jack");
 break;
 case 12:
 strcpy(pipstr, "Queen");
 break;
 case 13:
 strcpy(pipstr, "King");
 break;
 default:
 snprintf(pipstr, SMALLSTR, "%2i", c.pips);
 }
 switch(c.st){
 case hearts :
 strcpy(suitstr, "Hearts");
 break;
 case diamonds :
 strcpy(suitstr, "Diamonds");
 break;
 case spades:
 strcpy(suitstr, "Spades");
 break;
 default :
 strcpy(suitstr, "Clubs");
 }
 snprintf(s, BIGSTR, "%s of %s", pipstr, suitstr);
}
```

# snprintf() and sscanf()

```
#define FIRSTCARD " 1 of Hearts"
void test(void)
{
 int n = 0;
 char str[BIGSTR];
 card d[DECK];
 init_deck(d);
 // Direct assignment
 print_card(str, d[0]);
 // 1st element initialised correctly
 assert(strcmp(str, FIRSTCARD)==0);
 for(int i=0; i<1000; i++){
 shuffle_deck(d);
 print_card(str, d[0]);
 // Happens 1 time in 52 ?
 if(strcmp(str, FIRSTCARD)==0){
 n++;
 }
 }
 // Is this a reasonable test ?
 assert((n > 10) && (n < 30));
}
```



# sprintf() and sscanf()

```
#define FIRSTCARD " 1 of Hearts"
void test(void)
{
 int n = 0;
 char str[BIGSTR];
 card d[DECK];
 init_deck(d);
 // Direct assignment
 print_card(str, d[0]);
 // 1st element initialised correctly
 assert(strcmp(str, FIRSTCARD)==0);
 for(int i=0; i<1000; i++){
 shuffle_deck(d);
 print_card(str, d[0]);
 // Happens 1 time in 52 ?
 if(strcmp(str, FIRSTCARD)==0){
 n++;
 }
 }
 // Is this a reasonable test ?
 assert((n > 10) && (n < 30));
}
```

```
// Simple demo of sscanf (and fgets in passing)
#include <stdio.h>
#include <assert.h>

#define BIGSTR 1000
#define SMLSTR 100
#define DAYSINYEAR 365.2425

#include <stdio.h>

int main(void)
{
 printf("Please type your first name and your age\n");
 char bigstr[BIGSTR];
 fgets(bigstr, BIGSTR, stdin);
 char name[SMLSTR];
 int age;
 // Note no "&" before name : passed by reference already
 assert(sscanf(bigstr, "%s %i\n", name, &age)==2);
 printf("%s, you've lived approximately %.0f days\n",
 name, ((double)(age)+0.5)*DAYSINYEAR);
 return 0;
}
```

Execution :

```
Please type your first name and your age
Joe 25
Joe, you've lived approximately 9314 days
```

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**J : 2D Arrays & More Types**

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# Initializing 2D Arrays

A 2D array is declared as follows:

```
#define ROWS 3
#define COLS 5
int a[ROWS][COLS];
```

2D array initialisation :

```
int b[2][3] = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6};
int b[2][3] = {{1, 2, 3}, {4, 5, 6}};
int b[][3] = {{1, 2, 3}, {4, 5, 6}};
```

# Initializing 2D Arrays

A 2D array is declared as follows:

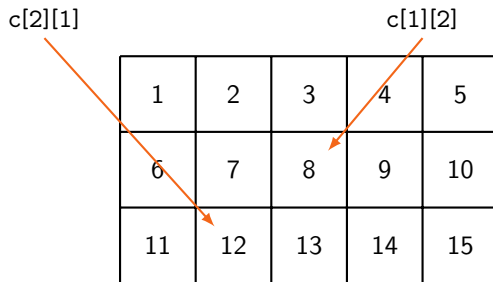
```
#define ROWS 3
#define COLS 5
int a[ROWS][COLS];
```

2D array initialisation :

```
int b[2][3] = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6};
int b[2][3] = {{1, 2, 3}, {4, 5, 6}};
int b[][3] = {{1, 2, 3}, {4, 5, 6}};
```

Although 2D arrays are stored in a contiguous block of memory, we may think of them as a 2D rectangle of data.

```
int c[3][5] = {{1,2,3,4,5}, {6,7,8,9,10},
 {11,12,13,14,15}};
```



# 2D Distance

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2 #include <math.h>
3
4 #define M 7
5 #define N 9
6
7 void fillarray(int a[M][N]);
8
9 int main(void)
10 {
11 int a[M][N];
12
13 fillarray(a);
14 // Print Array
15 for (int j = 0; j < M; j++){
16 for(int i = 0; i < N; i++){
17 printf("%i", a[j][i]);
18 }
19 printf("\n");
20 }
21 printf("\n");
22 return 0;
23 }
24
25 void fillarray(int a[M][N])
26 {
27 for (int j = 0; j < M; ++j){
28 double y = ((double)j - ((double)(M-1)/2.0));
29 for(int i = 0; i < N; ++i){ // Column-first
30 double x = ((double)i - ((double)(N-1)/2.0));
31 a[j][i] = round(sqrt(x*x + y*y));
32 }
33 }
34 }
```

# 2D Distance

```
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15 for (int j = 0; j < M; j++){
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17 printf("%i ", a[j][i]);
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32 }
33 }
34 }
```

Execution :

```
544333445
443222344
432111234
432101234
432111234
443222344
544333445
```

# Cards (again!)

```
#define SMALLSTR 20
void print_card(char s[BIGSTR], card c)
{
 // Note the +1 below : zero pips not used, but makes easier coding ?
 char pipnames[PERSUIT+1][SMALLSTR] = {"Zero", "One", "Two", "Three",
 "Four", "Five", "Six", "Seven",
 "Eight", "Nine", "Ten", "Jack",
 "Queen", "King"};

 char suitnames[SUITS][SMALLSTR] = {"Hearts", "Diamonds", "Spades", "Clubs"};
 snprintf(s, BIGSTR, "%s of %s", pipnames[c.pips], suitnames[c.st]);
}
```

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#define SMALLSTR 20
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 snprintf(s, BIGSTR, "%s of %s", pipnames[c.pips], suitnames[c.st]);
}
```

- The 2D arrays of characters here have one string per row.



# Cards (again!)

```
#define SMALLSTR 20
void print_card(char s[BIGSTR], card c)
{
 // Note the +1 below : zero pips not used, but makes easier coding ?
 char pipenames[PERSUIT+1][SMALLSTR] = {"Zero", "One", "Two", "Three",
 "Four", "Five", "Six", "Seven",
 "Eight", "Nine", "Ten", "Jack",
 "Queen", "King"};

 char suitnames[SUITS][SMALLSTR] = {"Hearts", "Diamonds", "Spades", "Clubs"};
 snprintf(s, BIGSTR, "%s of %s", pipenames[c.pips], suitnames[c.st]);
}
```

- The 2D arrays of characters here have one string per row.
- They are of a fixed-width, sometime called *ragged-right* or *jagged-right* arrays.

# Storage Classes

- **auto**

```
auto int a, b, c;
```

```
auto float f;
```

Because this is the default, it is seldom used.

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- **register**

Informs the compiler to place the variable in a high-speed memory register if possible, i.e. if there are enough such registers available & the hardware supports this.

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2 #include <stdlib.h>
3
4 void printstuff(void);
5
6 #define MAXLOOP 20
7
8 int main(void)
9 {
10 int r = rand() % MAXLOOP;
11 for(int i=0; i<r; i++){
12 printstuff();
13 }
14 return 0;
15 }
16
17 void printstuff(void)
18 {
19 static int cnt = 0;
20 printf("You've been here %i times\n", ++cnt);
21 }
```

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11 for(int i=0; i<r; i++){
12 printstuff();
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16
17 void printstuff(void)
18 {
19 static int cnt = 0;
20 printf("You've been here %i times\n", ++cnt);
21 }
```

Execution :

```
You've been here 1 times
You've been here 2 times
You've been here 3 times
```

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# Call-by-Value

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 void changex(int x);
4
5 int main(void)
6 {
7 int x = 1;
8
9 changex(x);
10 printf("%i\n", x);
11 return 0;
12 }
13
14 void changex(int x)
15 {
16 x = x + 1;
17 }
```

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```

Execution :

1

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Execution :

1

- In the program, the function cannot change the value of `x` as defined in `main()` since a **copy** is made of it.

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16 x = x + 1;
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```

Execution :

1

- In the program, the function cannot change the value of `x` as defined in `main()` since a **copy** is made of it.
- To allow a function to modify the value of a variable passed to it we need a mechanism known as **call-by-reference**, which uses the **address** of variables (pointers).

# Call-by-Value

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 void changex(int x);
4
5 int main(void)
6 {
7 int x = 1;
8
9 changex(x);
10 printf("%i\n", x);
11 return 0;
12 }
13
14 void changex(int x)
15 {
16 x = x + 1;
17 }
```

Execution :

1

- In the program, the function cannot change the value of `x` as defined in `main()` since a **copy** is made of it.
- To allow a function to modify the value of a variable passed to it we need a mechanism known as **call-by-reference**, which uses the **address** of variables (pointers).
- (strictly speaking, we're only simulating call-by-reference by passing an address using call-by-value, but we'll ignore this for now).

# Call-by-Reference

- We have already seen addresses used with `scanf()`. The function call:

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- `int i, *p;`

# Call-by-Reference

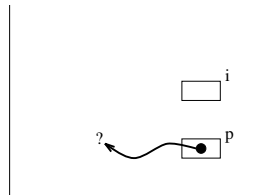
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- `int i, *p;`
- Here `i` is an `int` and `p` is of type *pointer to int*.

# Call-by-Reference

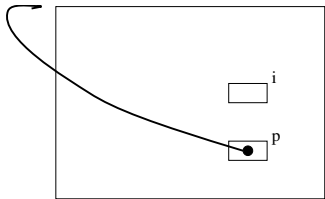
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- `int i, *p;`
- Here `i` is an `int` and `p` is of type *pointer to int*.
- Pointers have a legal range which includes the special address 0 and a set of positive integers which are the machine addresses of a particular system.



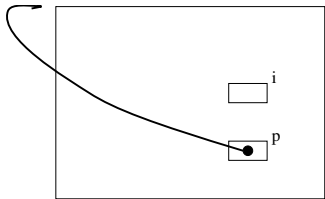
# The *NULL* Pointer

- `p = NULL;`



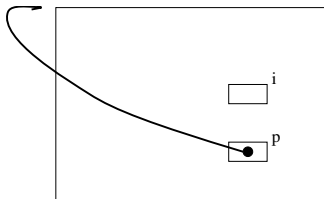
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- `p = NULL;`

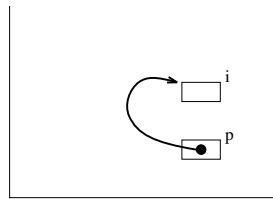


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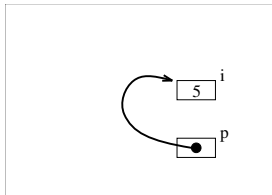


- `p = &i;`



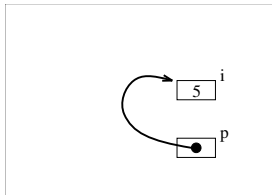
# Equivalence of $i$ and $*p$

- $i = 5;$



# Equivalence of $i$ and $*p$

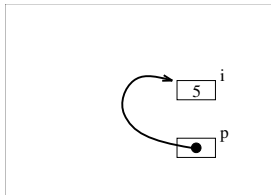
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# Equivalence of $i$ and $*p$

●  $i = 5;$



```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(void)
4 {
5
6 int i = 5;
7 int* p = &i;
8 printf("%i\n", *p);
9 i = 17;
10 printf("%i\n", *p);
11 *p = 99;
12 printf("%i\n", i);
13
14 return 0;
15
16 }
```

Execution :

5  
17  
99

# scanf Again

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(void)
4 {
5
6 int i;
7 int* p = &i;
8 printf("Please Type a number : ");
9 scanf("%i", &i);
10 printf("%i\n", i);
11 printf("Please Type a number : ");
12 scanf("%i", p);
13 printf("%i\n", i);
14
15 return 0;
16
17 }
```

Execution :

```
Please Type a number : 70
70
Please Type a number : 3
3
```

# scanf Again

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(void)
4 {
5
6 int i;
7 int* p = &i;
8 printf("Please Type a number : ");
9 scanf("%i", &i);
10 printf("%i\n", i);
11 printf("Please Type a number : ");
12 scanf("%i", p);
13 printf("%i\n", i);
14
15 return 0;
16
17 }
```

Execution :

```
Please Type a number : 70
70
Please Type a number : 3
3
```

- In many ways the dereference operator `*` is the inverse of the address operator `&`.

```
float x = 5, y = 8, *p;
p = &x;
y = *p;
```

# scanf Again

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(void)
4 {
5
6 int i;
7 int* p = &i;
8 printf("Please Type a number : ");
9 scanf("%i", &i);
10 printf("%i\n", i);
11 printf("Please Type a number : ");
12 scanf("%i", p);
13 printf("%i\n", i);
14
15 return 0;
16
17 }
```

Execution :

```
Please Type a number : 70
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```

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```
float x = 5, y = 8, *p;
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```

- What is this equivalent to ?

# The *swap* Function

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 void swap(int* p, int* q);
4
5 int main(void)
6 {
7 int a = 3, b = 7;
8
9 // 3 7 printed
10 printf("%i %i\n", a, b);
11 swap(&a, &b);
12 // 7 3 printed
13 printf("%i %i\n", a, b);
14 return 0;
15 }
16
17 void swap(int* p, int* q)
18 {
19 int tmp;
20
21 tmp = *p;
22 *p = *q;
23 *q = tmp;
24 }
```

Execution :

```
3 7
7 3
```

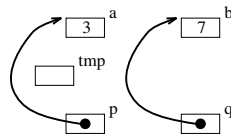
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- At beginning of function:



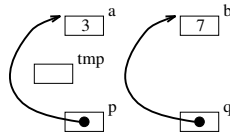
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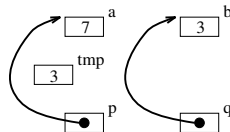
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- At end of function:



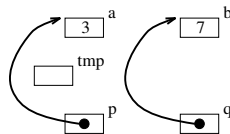
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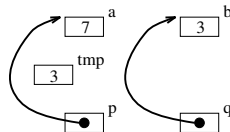
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- At end of function:



- Remember that the variables `a` and `b` are not in the scope of `swap()`.



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p = &a[1];
```
- Notice that `p = a + 1` advances the pointer **4** bytes and not 1 byte. This is because an integer is 4 bytes long and `p` is a pointer to an int.
- we can use the pointer `p` is exactly the same way as normal, i.e.:  

```
*p = 5;
```

# Summing an Array

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 #define NUM 5
4
5 int sum(int a[]);
6
7 int main(void)
8 {
9
10 int n[NUM] = {10, 12, 6, 7, 2};
11
12 printf("%i\n", sum(n));
13 return 0;
14 }
15
16 int sum(int a[])
17 {
18 int tot = 0;
19
20 for(int i=0; i<NUM; i++){
21 tot += a[i];
22 }
23 return tot;
24 }
```

Execution :

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# Pointers to Structures

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- But, like any other type, we could pass a pointer instead.
- The complication is that to access the elements of a structure via a pointer, we use the “->” operator, and not the “.”.

```
void print_deck(card d[DECK], int n)
{
 char str[BIGSTR];
 for(int i=0; i<n; i++){
 print_card(str, &d[i]);
 printf("%s\n", str);
 }
 printf("\n");
}

#define SMALLSTR 20
void print_card(char s[BIGSTR], const card* p)
{
 // Note the +1 below : zero pips not used, but makes easier coding ?
 char pipenames[PERSUIT+1][SMALLSTR] = {"Zero", "One", "Two", "Three",
 "Four", "Five", "Six", "Seven",
 "Eight", "Nine", "Ten", "Jack",
 "Queen", "King"};

 char suitnames[SUITS][SMALLSTR] = {"Hearts", "Diamonds", "Spades", "Clubs"};
 snprintf(s, BIGSTR, "%s of %s", pipenames[p->pi], suitnames[p->st]);
}
```

# Nested Structures

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 struct dateofbirth {
4 unsigned char day;
5 unsigned short month;
6 unsigned short year;
7 };
8 typedef struct dateofbirth dob;
9
10 typedef struct {
11 char* name;
12 dob date;
13 } person;
14
15 void print_byval(person b);
16 void print_byref(const person* p);
17
18 int main(void)
19 {
20 person a = {"Gary", {17, 5, 1999}};
21 print_byval(a);
22 print_byref(&a);
23 }
24
25 void print_byval(person b)
26 {
27 printf("%s %hu/%hi/%hi\n", b.name, b.date.day, b.date.month, b.date.year);
28 }
29
30 void print_byref(const person* p)
31 {
32 printf("%s %hu/%hi/%hi\n", p->name, p->date.day, p->date.month, p->date.year);
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```

Execution :

Gary 17/5/1999

Gary 17/5/1999



# Table of Contents

A: Preamble

B: Hello, World

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G: Prettifying (New Types and Aliasing)

H : Constructed Types - 1D Arrays & Structures

I : Strings

J : 2D Arrays & More Types

K : Pointers

**L : Advanced Memory Handling**

M : Files

# String Constants

```
1 // A FAILED attempt to
2 // convert all 'n' chars to 'N'
3 #include <stdio.h>
4 #include <stdlib.h>
5 #include <string.h>
6 #include <assert.h>
7
8 void nify(char s[]);
9
10 int main(void)
11 {
12
13 nify("neill");
14 return 0;
15 }
16
17 // In-Place : Swaps all 'n' -> 'N'
18 void nify(char s[])
19 {
20 for(int i=0; s[i]; i++){
21 if(s[i] == 'n'){
22 s[i] = 'N';
23 }
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26 }
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```
gcc nify1.c -g3 -fsanitize=undefined
-fsanitize=address -o nify1
```

we find that

```
s[i] = 'N';
```

is the culprit.

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- With the usual compile flags we get no more information.
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`gcc nify1.c -g3 -fsanitize=undefined -fsanitize=address -o nify1`  
we find that  

```
s[i] = 'N';
```

is the culprit.
- It turns out that in `main()` we have passed a **constant** string to the function. This is in a part of memory that we have read-only permission.

# Local Variables

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8 #define LINE 500
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10 char* nify(char s[]);
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15 char* s1 = nify("inconveniencing");
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17 assert(strcmp(s2, "Neill")==0);
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22 // Local copy : Swaps all 'n' -> 'N'
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- Now we try to create a copy of the string, and return a pointer to it.

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- The string t is local to nify().
- What happens in this memory when outside the scope of this function is completely undefined.

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- The pointers `s1` and `s2` are the same.



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11 assert(strcmp(s2, "Neill")==0);
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18 // malloc : Swaps all 'n' -> 'N'
19 char* nify(char s[])
20 {
21 int l = strlen(s);
22 char* t = (char*)malloc(l+1);
23 if(t==NULL){
24 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
25 }
26 strcpy(t, s);
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28 if(t[i] == 'n'){
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# Variable Length Arrays

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7 #define WORD 500
8
9 int main(void)
10 {
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12 char s[WORD];
13 assert(scanf("%s", s)==1);
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- Here we duplicate a string into *t*.

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- None of these is a problem if we use `malloc()`.

# Memory Leaks

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16 you have access to. Note forcing cast. */
17 char* t = (char*) malloc(n+1);
18 // If no space, returns NULL
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- This code appears to work correctly.
- However, it actually **leaks**. The memory allocated was never free()'d.

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3 #include <stdlib.h>
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5 #include <assert.h>
6
7 #define WORD 500
8
9 int main(void)
10 {
11 printf("Please type a string :\n");
12 char s[WORD];
13 assert(scanf("%s", s)==1);
14 int n = strlen(s);
15 /* malloc() returns a pointer to memory that
16 you have access to. Note forcing cast. */
17 char* t = (char*) malloc(n+1);
18 // If no space, returns NULL
19 assert(t != NULL);
20 // Deep copy: character by character
21 strcpy(t, s);
22 printf("%s %s\n", s, t);
23 return 0;
24 }
25
26 }
```

- This code appears to work correctly.
- However, it actually **leaks**. The memory allocated was never `free()`'d.
- This is best found by compiling the program using the sanitizer:

```
==201503==ERROR: LeakSanitizer: detected memory leaks
Direct leak of 6 byte(s) in 1 object(s) allocated from:
 #0 0x737ae50b4887 in __interceptor_malloc ../../src/libsanitizer/
asan/asan_malloc_linux.cpp:145
 #1 0x5845d6ac347c in main (/mnt/c/Users/csnwc/OneDrive - University
of Bristol/Dropbox/Lecturing/COMSM1201/strdup+0x147c)
 #2 0x737ae4429d8f in __libc_start_call_main ../sysdeps/nptl/libc_start
_call_main.h:58
SUMMARY: AddressSanitizer: 6 byte(s) leaked in 1 allocation(s).
```

# free()

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3 #include <string.h>
4 #include <assert.h>
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8 int main(void)
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15 char* t = (char*) malloc(n+1);
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18 /* Deep copy: character by character */
19 strcpy(t, s);
20 printf("%s %s\n", s, t);
21 /* All malloc'd memory must be freed
22 to prevent memory leaks */
23 free(t);
24 return 0;
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- This code is now correct.

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- This code is now correct.
- The sanitized code runs without any leak warnings.



# Structures with Self-Referential Pointers

```
1 // Store a list of numbers
2 #include <stdio.h>
3 #include <stdlib.h>
4 #include <assert.h>
5
6 struct data {
7 int num;
8 struct data* next;
9 };
10 typedef struct data data;
11
12 int main(void)
13 {
14 // a b c
15
16 // |11 -->|17 -->| 5 . |
17 data c = {5 , NULL};
18 data b = {17, &c};
19 data a = {11, &b};
20
21 // print first number
22 printf("%i\n", a.num);
23 data* p = &a;
24 // Can also get to it via p
25 printf("%i\n", p->num);
26 // Pointer chasing : The Key concept
27 p = p->next;
28 // We're accessing b, without using it's name
29 printf("%i\n", p->num);
30 p = p->next;
31 // And c
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- The structure contains a pointer to something of it's own type (even before we've fully defined the structure itself).

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33 return 0;
34 }
```

- The structure contains a pointer to something of it's own type (even before we've fully defined the structure itself).
- Here, if p points to a, then p->next->next points to c.

# Linked Lists

```
// Store a list of numbers (length unknown)
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <assert.h>

#define MAXNUM 20
#define ENDNUM 10

struct data {
 int num;
 struct data* next;
};
typedef struct data data;

void addtolist(data* tail);
void printlist(data* st);

int main(void)
{
 data *p, *start;
 start = p = calloc(1, sizeof(data));
 assert(p);
 p->num = rand()%MAXNUM;
 // Add other numbers to the list
 do{
 addtolist(p);
 p = p->next;
 }while(p->num != ENDNUM);
 printlist(start);
 // Need to free up list - not shown here ...
 return 0;
}
```

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 do{
 addtolist(p);
 p = p->next;
 }while(p->num != ENDNUM);
 printlist(start);
 // Need to free up list - not shown here ...
 return 0;
}
```

```
// Create some new space and store number in it
void addtolist(data* tail)
{
 tail->next = calloc(1, sizeof(data));
 assert(tail->next);
 tail = tail->next;
 tail->num = rand()%MAXNUM;
}

void printlist(data* st)
{
 while(st != NULL){
 printf("%i ", st->num);
 st = st->next;
 };
 printf("\n");
}
```

Execution :

3 6 17 15 13 15 6 12 9 1 2 7 10

- `calloc()` is similar to `malloc()`, but *clears* the memory it reserves for you. It's passed the number of array cells you wish to create, and the size of each of them.

# Table of Contents

A: Preamble

B: Hello, World

C: Grammar

D: Flow Control

E: Functions

F: Data Types, Maths and Characters

G: Prettifying (New Types and Aliasing)

H : Constructed Types - 1D Arrays & Structures

I : Strings

J : 2D Arrays & More Types

K : Pointers

L : Advanced Memory Handling

M : Files

# File Properties

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- They have a name.
- Until a file is opened nothing can be done with it.
- After use a file must be closed.
- Files may be read, written or appended.
- Conceptually a file may be thought of as a stream of characters.

```
1 /* Creates a file called helloworld.txt
2 in the current filespace and writes to it */
3 #include <stdio.h>
4 #include <stdlib.h>
5
6 int main(void)
7 {
8 // Clobber the file if it exists already
9 FILE* fp = fopen("helloworld.txt", "w");
10 if(fp == NULL){
11 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot open file?\n");
12 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
13 }
14 fprintf(fp, "Hello World!\n");
15 // fscanf() is also available to read in
16 fclose(fp);
17 return EXIT_SUCCESS;
18 }
```

# Reading and Writing

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2 #include <stdlib.h>
3 #include <string.h>
4 #define BIGSTR 500
5 #define FNAME "helloworld.txt"
6
7 int main(void)
8 {
9 FILE* fp = fopen(FNAME, "w");
10 if(fp == NULL){
11 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot open file %s ?\n", FNAME);
12 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
13 }
14 fprintf(fp, "Hello World!\n");
15 fclose(fp);
16
17 fp = fopen(FNAME, "r");
18 if(fp == NULL){
19 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot read file %s ?\n", FNAME);
20 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
21 }
22 char str[BIGSTR];
23 if(fgets(str, BIGSTR, fp) == NULL){
24 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot read 1st line of %s ?\n", FNAME);
25 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
26 }
27 fclose(fp);
28 // Newline is read too
29 if(strcmp(str, "Hello World!\n")){
30 fprintf(stderr, "1st line of %s not correct?\n", FNAME);
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- There are three files already open for you: `stdin`, `stdout` and `stderr`.
- Therefore `printf(...)` is just a shorthand for `fprintf(stdout, ...)`
- `fscanf()` could be used instead of `fgets()`.

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this will list all your files into myfile.txt

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    this will list all your files into myfile.txt
- The ">" at the prompt redirects the output (or "<" input) to file rather than screen.
- If something went wrong though, the user would never see the message.
- Therefore, stderr exists so that there is a stream to display warnings/errors to the user.

# Interlude : argc/v

- A traditional C program has  
`int main(int argc, char* argv[]);`

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(int argc, char* argv[])
4 {
5
6 printf("You typed %i arguments\n", argc);
7 printf("The name of your executable is : %s\n", argv[0]);
8 for(int i=1; i<argc; i++){
9 printf("Argument %d is : %s\n", i, argv[i]);
10 }
11
12 return 0;
13 }
```

Execution :

```
$./usingargs -c doof groob
You typed 4 arguments
The name of your executable is : ./usingargs
Argument 1 is : -c
Argument 2 is : doof
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- `argv` is an array of **pointers to chars** - i.e. an array of strings.
- This is not a traditional 2D array of characters - it's a 1D array of pointers - each string could be a different length.

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(int argc, char* argv[])
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5
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- A traditional C program has  
`int main(int argc, char* argv[]);`
- `argc` is the number of words typed on the command line to execute the program.
- `argv` is an array of **pointers to chars** - i.e. an array of strings.
- This is not a traditional 2D array of characters - it's a 1D array of pointers - each string could be a different length.
- This is sometimes known as a ragged-right or jagged array.

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2
3 int main(int argc, char* argv[])
4 {
5
6 printf("You typed %i arguments\n", argc);
7 printf("The name of your executable is : %s\n", argv[0]);
8 for(int i=1; i<argc; i++){
9 printf("Argument %d is : %s\n", i, argv[i]);
10 }
11
12 return 0;
13 }
```

Execution :

```
$./usingargs -c doof groob
You typed 4 arguments
The name of your executable is : ./usingargs
Argument 1 is : -c
Argument 2 is : doof
Argument 3 is : groob
```

# Back to Files : One Character at a Time

```
1 // Some of the functionality of cp
2 #include <stdio.h>
3 #include <stdlib.h>
4
5 int main(int argc, char* argv[])
6 {
7 if(argc != 3){
8 fprintf(stderr, "Usage : %s <filein> <fileout>\n", argv[0]);
9 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
10 }
11 FILE* fpin = fopen(argv[1], "r");
12 if(!fpin){
13 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot read from %s\n", argv[1]);
14 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
15 }
16 FILE* fpout = fopen(argv[2], "w");
17 if(!fpout){
18 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot write to %s\n", argv[2]);
19 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
20 }
21
22 char c;
23 while((c = fgetc(fpin)) != EOF){
24 fputc(c, fpout);
25 }
26 fclose(fpin);
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\$ cp oldfile.txt newfile.txt

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- fgetc() and fputc() are the file equivalents of getchar and putchar.

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- Here we save an entire array to a binary file - another program could read this in later.

```
1 /* Compute some factorials and save them
2 for another program to read back later. */
3 #include <stdio.h>
4 #include <stdlib.h>
5
6 #define FACTS 20
7
8 typedef unsigned long facttype;
9
10 int main(int argc, char* argv[])
11 {
12 if(argc != 2){
13 fprintf(stderr, "Usage : %s <fileout>\n", argv[0]);
14 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
15 }
16 FILE* fpout = fopen(argv[1], "wb");
17 if(!fpout){
18 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot write to %s\n", argv[1]);
19 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
20 }
21 facttype facts[FACTS] = {1};
22 for(facttype i=1; i<FACTS; i++){
23 facts[i] = facts[i-1]*i;
24 }
25
26 int n = fwrite(facts, sizeof(facttype), FACTS, fpout);
27 if(n != FACTS){
28 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot write to %s\n", argv[1]);
29 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
30 }
31 fclose(fpout);
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- You should generally avoid assuming line endings - use a function that reads entire lines at once such as fgets().
- When you open a file in textmode fopen("file.txt", "rt") some automatic translation may be done on input/output.

```
1 #include <stdio.h>
2 #include <stdlib.h>
3 #include <string.h>
4
5 #define BIGSTR 10000
6
7 int main(int argc, char* argv[])
8 {
9 if(argc != 2){
10 fprintf(stderr, "Usage : %s <file>\n", argv[0]);
11 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
12 }
13 FILE* fpin = fopen(argv[1], "rb");
14 if(!fpin){
15 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot read %s\n", argv[1]);
16 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
17 }
18 char str[BIGSTR];
19 if(fgets(str, BIGSTR, fpin)==NULL){
20 fprintf(stderr, "Cannot read %s\n", argv[1]);
21 exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
22 }
23 int n = strlen(str);
24 if(n > 1){
25 if((str[n-1] == '\n') && (str[n-2] == '\r')){
26 printf("Looks like a DOS file?\n");
27 }
28 else{
29 printf("Looks like a Unix file?\n");
30 }
31 }
32 fclose(fpin);
33 return EXIT_SUCCESS;
34 }
```